Union Conference Record

"Be strong all ye people, saith the Lord, and work; for I am with you."

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"THAT THE OFFERING UP OF THE GENTILES MIGHT BE MADE ACCEPTABLE."

ROMANS 15 : 16.

Entrancing vision, high and daring thought,
Within the heart of the Apostle wrought!
The vision held in ken the Gentile world,
Saw floating o'er it Love's red flag unfurled.
Despite its deep corruption, heinous sin,
It might become "all glorious within."
'Twas his to publish the evangel glad
To weary men, unutterably sad.
His trust was in the Spirit's cleansing tide,
Fitting e'en Gentiles to be Christ's own bride.
His gaze sweeps o'er these many peopled lands,
He holds them forth to God with outstretched hands.
This offering, on love's mighty passion swept,
The Father heart must joyfully accept.
The vision tarries. To our cry give heed!
The coming of Thy blessed kingdom speed.
Send yet more men of apostolic mould,
Whose burning love for souls can ne'er be told.
O multiply the rapt and glowing seers
Whose prescient glance slays all unworthy fears.
The Gentile world is on Thine altar laid,
And on Thy faithfulness our trust is stayed.

—*Edward Strutt.*

Early Experiences in the Publishing Work.—No. 10.

"IF the workers who have seen God's dealing with His people during the rise and progress of the cause will strengthen the faith of the people of God by reviewing past blessings and mercies, they themselves will be blessed, and their work will prove a blessing to those who have not had the experience they have had. As they recount the sacrifices made by those who led out in the work, and tell of the power of God manifested to keep His cause free from error and extravagance, they will have a moulding influence for good.

"Those who enter the work at the present time know comparatively little of the self-denial and self-sacrifice of those upon whom the Lord laid the burden of His work at the beginning. The experiences of the past should be told them again and again; for they are to carry forward the work with the same humility and self-sacrifice that characterized the true workers in the past." —*E. G. White, in Review of June 3, 1902.*

We have called attention to the commencement of the publication of the little paper called *Present Truth*. As the type-setting and printing were secured from the secular press, the paper could be moved from place to place, as the interest in the labours of Brother and Sister White demanded, and as the brethren provided a home for them. From July to September, 1849, four numbers were printed at Middletown, Connecticut. The next six numbers were published at Oswego, New York, from December, 1849, to May, 1850. During that time Brother and Sister White had meetings in Oswego and that vicinity. They were set up in housekeeping in a room in the home of Brother Elias Goodwin, with furniture loaned to them by the few Sabbath-keepers in Oswego.

There was a peculiar and striking experience in the conversion of Brother Goodwin, who entertained these pioneer labourers. This I will relate as he told it to me when I first became acquainted with him, in the winter of 1854-5. He said that in 1843, and for many years previous, he was an expert gambler, and, in fact, made his living by gambling. He said that his nights were spent at the gambling-tables, and his sleep was made up in the day time. There came a night when he expected to stay at the table with the games, but somehow he lost all interest in the game and made up his mind early in the evening to go home. As he was walking along the street he passed by an open stairway that led up into a hall. Some one was preaching very earnestly in the hall, and he began to ascend the steps to see what was going on there. His interest led him into the hall, and he took a seat, and listened to a stirring discourse on the prophecy of Daniel. He said that, as he sat and listened, he was impressed that the speaker was in need of money. When the meeting closed, he walked up to him, and gave him five dollars (one pound); but before he got down the stairs he was cursing himself for giving the man the money. He went home to sleep, but the image and beasts of Daniel were constantly before him, and the solemn impression was on his mind that the end of all things was right at hand. His conviction was such that he left his gambling, and sought the hall where he first heard this message. He listened to other speakers, and was soundly converted to God and united with the advent believers in the city.

Then his anxiety was to find out the man whom he first heard speak upon the subject of the second advent. After a few months the same man came again, and said to the audience that there was a wonderful experience connected with his first visit to that place. He said, "When I started out to preach the near coming of the Lord, I told Him I would go as long as He opened the way. As I came on the steamer to this city, an entire stranger, I had only fifty cents (two shillings) left. I prayed most earnestly in my cabin. I said, 'Lord, if my work is done, I can as well stop in Oswego as anywhere else; but if there is more for me to do, open the way.' At the close of my sermon, a man handed me five dollars, and I have not lacked since. None of the brethren could tell who the man was; I would like to meet him."

At the close of that service Brother Goodwin stepped up and said, "I am the man who gave you the five dollars; I want you to come home with me." What a glorious time they had in praise to God, as they related their experiences!

Such was one of the providences of the Lord in preparing a home for His

servants, and especially for Brother and Sister White in their second move in the publishing work. Many a pleasant hour have I also spent in that pilgrim's home, which was ever after open for the care of the Lord's ministers.

J. N. LOUGHBOROUGH.

Our Missions

Medical Missionary Work in Java.

THE writer accompanied Miss Nordstrom, one of our Sydney Sanitarium nurses, in one of her rounds among the villages of Java where she was giving treatments. We left the Java Health Retreat, our beautiful mountain rest home at Soember Wekas, just after dinner one day, and rode on little Arabian ponies to the villages.

As we passed through a village where our workers had given treatments before, we noticed the hearty greeting accorded by the native villagers. As a rule, in Java the natives never speak to a passing traveller, in fact they do not seem to understand you when you greet them—it is such an unusual thing for the Europeans to do such a thing. We are glad that our workers are breaking through these customs, and that the people so long in sin and darkness are yet responsive to that mighty conqueror, Love.

How quickly the heathen can measure our religion! You may preach to them about Jesus, the Saviour of mankind, telling them He loved all men, that He loved all races of whatsoever colour, and that He was no respector of persons; but if they see a barrier built up between the missionary and themselves, the missionary treating them as though they belonged to a lower planet, all this preaching will avail little. How few missionaries to-day take the Master's place in loving, heart-to-heart ministrations.

Passing by cornfields, over beautiful terraced hills, cultivated to the very tops, and through luxuriant valleys, we soon come to a village where the second treatment is to be given to a sick man.

We find him improved, and thankful for our coming. Here, perhaps for the first time for centuries, a Christian prayer is offered. How our hearts long to see the name of God known and reverenced among these heathen.

The next village was entered to treat a poor blind man who also had been treated once before. He was cordial in his greetings, and told how much he had been benefited. We thought of leaving him to go to more needy cases, but he would not have it so. He remarked that the water was hot, and that he wanted more fomentations. His spine was giving him [illegible] trouble, so a fomentation was ap[illegible] to his back, just below the neck. We had difficulty in making ourselves understood to each other; for some reason he thought that the fomentation should start at the top of his head, perhaps thinking that to be more systematic, and so he removed it to that place, the nurse yielding to his whim. He allowed the next fomentation to remain where the first was placed, but every succeeding one was pushed a little farther down until at last he wanted one just above his knees. He hugged each fomentation to him with such evident satisfaction, seeming to think that there was real virtue being received, and we have no doubt that this was true.

At the door we counted eighty persons who were lookers on, while on a small hill near by were many others. We asked if they knew of God. The answer was, "No, we know Him not." We long to be able to tell in their own language the wonderful truths for this time. As we are about to leave, others apply for help. We think of the time when Jesus ministered to the people, and long for more of His grace and power. But as far as was in the power of the nurse, none were turned away without some offer of help.

Other villages were visited, and difficult cases treated. Some seem almost helpless, having gone so long without attention. But they were left in the care of the Great Physician to await His will. While we were attending a chief who had been sick for a long time, a thunder-storm came up and the rain fell in torrents. Fortunately we were under shelter. Our horses were brought into the house with us, so that they and the saddles would be kept dry for us.

It is a common thing in this country for people, horses, cows, goats, and fowls, all to have the shelter of one roof. The little pony belonging to the mission has not had his house completed at this writing, but the gardener who keeps up the grounds at the retreat takes him home every night and gives him shelter with himself in the house.

One sick man, feeble and emaciated with months of disease, come to the retreat a few days ago asking for medical aid. While massaging his feet and the calves of his legs, the nurse discovered a long needle buried in the fleshy portion of each leg. These, the patient explained, a native doctor had inserted some three years before to cure his malarial fever, as they were warranted to prevent any further attacks.

Our journey homeward was completed about eight o'clock at night. We were thankful to have had this pleasurable experience. And as we saw what is being done for the poor people, we felt to denominate it gospel work of the highest order. And after seeing what is to be done for these many millions, we pray that the "Lord of the harvest will send forth labourers into His harvest."

J. E. FULTON.

Singapore.

WEDNESDAY, November 25, was a happy day at the mission in this city. Early in the morning we all went to the wharf to wait for the boat on which Brother and Sister Jones, accompanied by Brother Hungerford, together with Brother and Sister Fulton, who had been a month in Java, were returning from Australia. As the boat came alongside we soon recognized them, and were glad to see every one looking so well. The rounded features and smiling faces of Brother and Sister Jones were evidences of the good time they had had in Australia, and these evidences were warmly supplemented by words of praise and thankfulness for the kindness and hospitality of our Australian brethren and sisters.

Those in the home land can scarcely realize the good their sympathy and appreciation do to the workers whose places are in the front of the battle. I often think of the Levites bearing the ark; what a strength and encouragement it surely was to them, as they walked down into the waters of the Jordan, to know that three million Israelites were behind them with their loins girt up and their staves in their hands. Those Levites would have walked on, at the command to "Go forward," until the waters had rolled over their heads, rather than have turned back when supported by such a company.

Long before our company arrived at the mission the usual questioning had begun, and after two or three days it showed but slight signs of abating. What a pleasure it is to talk to those who have recently seen our loved ones. It is next to talking with them ourselves. We were heartily glad to accord to Brother and Sister Fulton a

welcome to Malaysia, and also to see them looking so well. Their stay in the mountain home in Java, they said, had been a help to them. Neither was Brother Hungerford's coming less welcome. Such young men are needed here by the score. Indeed, if all our brethren and sisters in Australasia were to come here, places could be found for them, and then there would be territory to spare.

This field spreads over an area equal to Europe, and one island alone, Borneo, is large enough to cover the whole of the British Isles. There are three islands larger than Great Britain; Sumatra is about the same size as Great Britain; Java and the Celebes contain fifty thousand square miles each; eighteen more islands are as large as Jamaica; besides islands of smaller size and islets almost without number. In one island alone there are said to be thirty-two different languages and dialects spoken, and among the written languages of the archipelago there are nine different alphabets.

These native peoples are exceedingly interesting. One soon learns to love them. The simplicity of their lives draws us to them. I like to be at the door when they come making inquiries. It interests me to hear them ask for "Missi Tinggi" or "Missi Gmok" (tall or stout), or "Tuan Bsar" (Great Tuan Jones—of course referring to his position). Our names are just as difficult for them to remember and to say as are theirs for us. Their efforts at English are not less interesting. Here is the advertisement of a *dhoby* (washerman): "I wash ladies thirty cents a dozen, gentlemen thirty-five. All customers executed promptly." Their lives are less artificial than are the lives of those who live in more civilized lands, and they are possessed of a simplicity of manners which is quite attractive.

Brother Jacob van der Groep, our Dutch labourer from Holland, has now been in Singapore for several weeks. He is a young man of twenty-three, and speaks Dutch and German and a little English. Next week he, with Brother Lee Chong Miou, is going to Deli in Sumatra to canvass for Dutch books, while Brother Lee canvasses for the Malay "Christ Our Saviour."

Brother Parkins writes from Shanghai that he is feeling a little better, and that, if he continues to improve, he will come down to Singapore early next year. Of this we are exceedingly glad. It is to be hoped that he will recover sufficiently to be able to continue his work in the East. It is with sorrow that we part with Brother and Sister Mills. It is plainly evident, however, that if they are to be preserved for the work, they must go to a more invigorating climate. This is a very pleasant and interesting country; it is as near like Paradise as is any place I have ever seen: but unfortunately the climatic influences are most seductive and debilitating. One feels no inconvenience at first, and sees no reason for extra caution. It is not long, though, before the fact is forced upon one that one's vitality is at a very low ebb, and there is but little power left to resist any disease to which he may be exposed. Women are more susceptible to the weakening influences of the climate than are men. I read in the local paper that European ladies resident here have to spend one year out of three in some cold climate.

Council meetings are now being held for the rearrangement of the work here, and to carry out the plans proposed at the late Union Conference. Of these meetings we shall send a report later.

GEORGE TEASDALE.

A Pleasant Occasion in Padang, Sumatra.

LAST week we had a very pleasant time with the children whom we invited to our mission home. Some special preparations had been made for them, with pleasant surprises in little bags which they could take home. The bags being made of a variety of coloured prints, were prized especially by the little girls.

We fixed up a four-masted sailing-ship with full sails, with the colours of every nation flying from bow to stern; these were donated by Mr. Kranich, the grocer. The "gallant ship" was laden with a cargo of little sacks of rice, choice wood, cinnamon, etc.

The ship, with its thirty sheets of miniature sails, measured about five feet in length, and stood on a platform decorated with palm leaves and flowers, at the back of which stood a fragrant box-tree, upon the branches of which was fixed a variety of coloured wax candles, illuminating the whole. Both in appearance and sweet perfume the blossoms of the box-tree (which are out in profusion at present) resemble the lovely pure white jasmine.

About fifteen minutes were devoted to singing and prayer, and a short exhortation "to get ready for the soon coming of Jesus, to take His obedient and happy children to the beautiful place He has gone to prepare." It sounded good to us to hear these Dutch voices raised (in their own tongue) to sing the good old tune—

"There's a land that is fairer than day,
And by faith we can see it afar,
For the Father waits over the way
To prepare us a dwelling-place there."

If ever I enjoyed addressing a company of souls, it was surely on this occasion, when these children, with eager eyes and mouths open, took in all that was said.

One very pleasing sight to my soul was to see the chairs and seats we had made with our own hands, crowded with eager little bodies whom Jesus loves and longs to save for His kingdom.

To be served and waited upon with refreshments at the hands of Europeans was regarded as a new departure from East Indian etiquette.

Some of the parents who were present seemed to enjoy the gathering as much as did their children. We in turn felt grateful for this another opportunity of enabling us to come closer to precious souls for whom Jesus died.

We pray that each soul of these parents and children who honoured the invitation to this occasion with their personal presence, may be wise in responding to the higher invitation, and at last sit down in the kingdom of God, and partake of the pleasures prepared for evermore, when Jesus Himself will serve.

G. A. WANTZLICK.

November 27, 1908.

From Australia to Tahiti.

IT will be remembered that at our last Union Conference Brother and Sister Thomas from South Australia were asked to make Pitcairn Island their field of labour. As Sister (Tuxen) Thomas has had experience in teaching as well as in other lines of work, it was thought that they could render good service in this needy and isolated field.

They sailed from Sydney on November 18 for their distant field, going by way of Auckland, New Zealand. A letter has just come to hand from Sister Thomas, dated December 3 and written from Tahiti. We give the following from this letter:—

I know you will be pleased to hear that we have reached Tahiti safely. We had a splendid trip all the way, neither of us suffering from sea-sickness. The first island we called at after leaving Auckland was Rarotonga, and it was quite a revelation to us to see how beautiful it is—just one large garden, with ferns, palms, and fruit in profusion; and the natives,

who all turned out in holiday attire, added to the picturesqueness of the scene. They all seemed very happy and animated, for it is a general holiday when the boat arrives.

As we started out on our walk to "Arorangi," our mission, we met Brother Lyndon driving down for his mail. We got in with him and had a delightful drive to his home, where we were pleased to meet Sister Lyndon and the two little girls. We were regaled with a feast of fruit — mummy-apples, mangoes, etc. — and just had time to look around before returning to the boat.

We were surprised to see some of the natives riding bicycles, others riding small horses, that looked almost like donkeys; while others again drove in buggies or carts, and still others walked in groups. The whole scene was one of animation and good fellowship.

After a further journey of two days we reached Raiatea, and here we were pleased to meet Brother Cady, who came on board the boat with us to Tahiti. In all these islands a flower called the Tiare Tahiti grows in profusion, which is much like the frangipani or anberose in scent, strong and fragrant. The natives appear to be very fond of this flower, for men and women alike are to be seen with wreaths of it around their hats, sometimes on their heads without hats, until the air is heavy with its scent, and one is glad to get away from it.

We have now reached Tahiti, another beautiful island, with quite a good harbour. Here we have landed, and are now at Brother Cady's house. We had to pass the customs officers, whom we saw very carefully examining everything some of the passengers had in their luggage. Here the French manner of living is adopted. They have an early cup of coffee, breakfast at 11 a.m., and dinner at 5 p.m. All business places are closed from 10 a.m. to noon, then open until 5 p.m. and again after dinner. Ten o'clock had arrived and the long wharf was rapidly deserted, so we had to leave our luggage to be overhauled after twelve. I found my knowledge of French stood me in good stead, for the customs officer does not understand a word of English. He did not look through much of our luggage, and we were pleased not to have to turn out everything.

We have already met some of the Pitcairn Islanders. They seem warm-hearted people, and welcomed us to the islands. Brother and Sister Cady are preparing to leave for America by the *Mariposa*, which sails in three days. They are thinking of leaving us here until they return, as there will be plenty for us to do, and we may be able to bring the message before some of the French people.

While some things are new to us, we expect that we will soon adapt ourselves to these changes, and, with the help that we know our Heavenly Father will give us, that we may be able to do the work He has for us to do in these islands.

"DO NOT pray, 'Lord, use me'; God is using you to the utmost of His power: pray rather, 'Lord, make me usable.'"

Closing Exercises of Buresala School, Fiji.

NOVEMBER 30 was the date on which the above exercises were to be held; and long before the sun was up, there was unusual activity in the town. The students began early to decorate the little schoolhouse for this important occasion. Numerous long vines, selected from the bush, were twined neatly around the posts and along the beams and rafters: while outside the decorations were more native-like.

At 10 a.m. visitors and students assembled, and the exercises were commenced with singing and prayer. English songs and native solos were rendered in proper native style. A speech was then given by the town chief, in which he likened the school to a large fire. He showed plainly the possibility of one's growing cold when separated from the school, and exhorted the students to keep their hearts warm with the love of the truth.

In the afternoon a European dinner was given in the bush, after which native speeches were called for, and a very enjoyable afternoon was spent. The day following, a number of the students left for their native towns, with the determination to diffuse the light shed upon their pathway.

When we understand the power of the gospel, it is not surprising to see the earnestness and devotion of these native students. Thus, little by little, the truth is being sent to the numerous islands of Fiji, and already we are hearing of the good results.

T. A. DRIVER.

"BE frank, loyal, truthful. If a lapse is sometimes made—for we all of us are but dust—be quick to admit your fault. 'Let not the sun go down upon your wrath.'"

THE first lesson to learn in the happy art of making home happy is to be content with simple and common things. The farther you go from the every-day paths of life in search of happiness, the less likely you are to find it. A thankful heart makes the best dinner, a pleasant voice the best music, a kind look is a more beautiful picture than was ever painted by all masters, old or new. These are things that all can command. They can be had for the humblest home without money and without price.—*March.*

Field Work

Lithgow, New South Wales.

KNOWING that many fervent prayers have ascended to the heavenly courts on behalf of the work here, and having had the opportunity for the last two months of watching the interest, we readily pass on to the readers of the RECORD a report of the progress of the truth in this place and the attitude of the people toward us.

When we returned from the camp-meeting we were heartily welcomed by the interested ones, and we at once started aggressive work by visiting and holding nightly studies. Every day people asked us to enter their homes and unfold to them our views, and this spirit of inquiry has opened the way so that Brother Brittain has engagements every night, while most of my evenings are also occupied. Sunday-night meetings were held in the mission home until the attendance became too large for the house to hold all that came. This clearly indicated that we should enlarge our borders, which we did by taking a hall. We have advertised our hall services freely, through the papers and by hand-bills, and we are rejoiced to have the hall filled with people desirous of hearing the message from Brother Brittain. I feel sure that a reference to one or two of the cases of the interested ones, will show clearly the nature of the work here.

A hospital nurse from Burraga was here for a few days on a visit to some relatives, who were interested, and some of whom had connected themselves with the cause. She by persuasion consented to attend one of our meetings, and accordingly formed one of the company at the Sabbath-afternoon service. After the meeting, in speaking to her she expressed her appreciation of the way in which we unfolded God's Word, and stated that she would not absent herself from any of the meetings held during her stay in Lithgow.

True to her word, she came regularly every evening, heard, and was convinced; and, hastening to walk in the way of truth, she determined to keep the next Sabbath. She was with us only five days. Brother Brittain had several studies with her during her short stay, so that by the time she left she had heard the main points of our faith.

Since then we have heard regularly

from her, and each succeeding letter has more of the ring of the message, so that we know she is progressing. She has taken a bold stand amid opposition from the hospital officials and her relatives at home.

Then there is an elderly gentleman residing in the town whose straightforwardness and honesty in business has made him highly respected and influential. He started to attend, and became interested, so that when I asked him if he would like us to call upon him and talk further on these things, he was only too pleased with the suggestion. Since then he has steadily grown in the knowledge of the truth. We are now studying the Sabbath question with him, and he is being deeply stirred by it. He expresses his anxiety to do God's bidding. We feel sure that this dear soul will walk in the way of God's commandments.

Last Tuesday night I held a study with another of the interested ones. He rested his arguments on Col. 2 : 16, which seemed at first reading to be a loophole of escape. He told me he had taken this text to the elderly gentleman whom I have mentioned before ; but this honest soul, instead of seeing in it a way of escape, said he had utter confidence in our ability to show that that text does not apply to the seventh-day Sabbath.

We are glad to learn that we are gaining the confidence of the people, and pray earnestly that we shall so conduct our studies as to impress them with the importance of making the Word of God their sole rule of faith. I might multiply the evidences that we are having of the working of the Spirit of God on the hearts of the people, but space will not permit.

In my paper work I find no difficulty in disposing of the *Signs*. The people seem eager to have them. We wish you all to unite your prayers with ours, that the Lord will perform a good work here, and that many souls will be established in this message, to be a memorial here of what God can and will do for those who put their trust in Him.

CECIL K. MEYERS.

"ONE buttonhole bouquet offered amid life's stress of trial is worth a thousand wreaths of roses laid on the coffin of the man who died discouraged and broken-hearted."

THE love of God must master the world's attraction, or, if not, then the soul is "like the troubled sea when it cannot rest."—*F. W. Robertson.*

Galston and Arcadia, New South Wales.

IT will be of interest to the readers of the RECORD to learn of the steady progress of the cause in the districts of Galston and Arcadia.

Sunday, December 13, we were gathered together at the Berowra Creek for the third time within a year, to celebrate the solemn ordinance of baptism. This time there were five candidates, making a total of thirty-six in all. Quite a number of our own people and also friends from the district were present on this occasion. One impressive feature of the service was the number of testimonies borne to God's faithfulness, to victories gained, and to a confidence in the third angel's message.

ORGANIZATION.

Sabbath, December 26, we all assembled for the first time at our church building, Arcadia Road, Arcadia. This was a day of joy. We wish all might have seen this new church. It is a neat, well-ventilated, fully finished and well-equipped building, with a seating capacity of one hundred.

On this occasion the church was organized and officers appointed in the forenoon; while we celebrated the ordinances in the afternoon. It was a very precious season, and the hearts of all were softened. It is encouraging to see the growth in grace of these dear brethren and sisters, and especially so since many of them had never before made a profession of Christ.

DEDICATION.

The following day, Sunday, at 3.30 p.m., we were again assembled to dedicate the building and all its furnishings to the service of God. Pastor Woods was with us, and spoke on the second coming of Christ.

Before the dedicatory prayer was offered, the secretary of the building committee, Brother Gilles, read a partial report and presented the financial standing. We found that we were a little over eighteen pounds short of meeting our liabilities. From the very first we had worked to the end of dedicating the church free of debt, and as each one was anxious that this should be done, a collection was taken up, and this, with pledges to be paid within a few weeks' time, made up the required amount. We feel deeply grateful to the Lord that we were able to present His house to Him free from debt.

The church is finished and painted inside and out. It is well-lighted, and seated with comfortable seats. Two suitable chairs for the rostrum and a very serviceable carpet for the platform and aisle were donated ; and all things necessary for celebrating the ordinances were purchased. Then to assist materially in the worship of God, a good organ was purchased. This with table, desk, a good tank, and a full set of the "Testimonies for the Church," all add to the comfort and convenience of the worshippers, and to the stability of the work. There was a general feeling of satisfaction and gratitude.

The Sunday-evening service was blessed of God, and two more decided to cast in their lot with the remnant people of God, and go through to the kingdom.

May the Lord bless the officers and members of the Arcadia Church. We might also add that this church has a real live band of young people. Each one has had a part in the building fund, and the spirit of sacrifice has been manifested on their part. One of the young men is going to Avondale this year to prepare for the work.

F. W. PAAP.

Corndale Church-School.

THE readers of the UNION CONFERENCE RECORD will, we feel sure, be interested to hear something concerning the church-school at Corndale, Richmond River, New South Wales.

This nice little church-school was opened on May 27, 1908, when Brother James Hill presided, and an excellent programme was rendered.

The neat school building stands on a highly elevated piece of land which was donated by Brother William Arthur. A more desirable site for a church-school it would be hard to find. The expense of building the school was borne almost entirely by Brethren Hill and Arthur.

Sister Walker is the teacher. She is indeed fortunate in having extremely nice and well-behaved pupils. A few outside children are attending the school, and appear to be deeply interested in their lessons.

Each pupil has his or her own missionary garden plot, from which they have sold many kinds of vegetables. The enrolment throughout has stood at eleven. The school is provided with single desks very similar to those used at Cooranbong. These desks were manufactured in Lismore.

H. E. A. MINCHIN.

Our Canvassers

HAPPINESS.

Why should we not make friends with happiness?
Life has its grieving moments, it is true,
And daily cares—but O it's rapture too!
Why should we gather thorns when flowers press
About our feet, and sweet wild things confess
Their inner radiance, as if they knew
There shone for us behind the steadfast blue
A love that asks no guerdon but to bless?

—*Helen A. Saxton.*

Do You Call Back Again?

ONE of our agents when sending in his report for the week, wrote as follows:—

"The lady where we are staying is very kind. When I offered her the money for my room she refused it, and said she would take it out in singing; so we sing in the morning, also at night.

"Most of the orders taken this week were refused more than once. I had been out all day and was returning without success, when a storm drove me to a house where we had already shown the book. Storms became the topic of conversation, opening the way, with the result that I secured the order for a leather binding.

"Next day I was refused at one home, and later returned for directions. I turned the conversation to my book, and recanvassed, and secured another leather order.

"Later I met another man whom I had canvassed twice before. I again referred to my book and secured his order. I feel the Lord has been good to me."

Probably many others have been lost because the people have not had the opportunity of meeting the canvasser after the first presentation of the book. We should always leave the people in such a manner that they will be pleased to have us call again, and often by returning we shall find they have reconsidered their decision, and are anxious to secure the book.

In town work especially, let us plan to call back often, thus giving the people the opportunity once more to secure our books. L. M. GREGG.

A Retrospect.—No. 2.

ADAPTABILITY OF THE CANVASSER.

MANY a young canvasser who has been reared amid rural surroundings, or forced at a subsequent period to adapt himself to them, has wondered how the knowledge gained would be of much service in selling books. The following is an illustration of the value of an all-round education:—

When making a large delivery a few weeks ago, I reached a farm-house on a Friday afternoon to find there a horse in the last stages of spasmodic colic. The farmer and neighbours had laboured all day to save their dumb friend, and had been forced at last to relinquish hope as he slowly sank. A glance showed that only the most speedy means could save his life. So breathing an earnest prayer to God for special assistance (as the farmer a few weeks before, when I tried to canvass him, had intimated very strongly his distaste for Adventism), I started to work with hot fomentations and such other hygienic treatments as were available; and worked the harder for knowing that I had a book to deliver to his son, with the result that before long the horse was completely out of danger.

Thus I had gained the confidence of this hard-shelled Methodist, and next morning he insisted upon my taking one pound for my services. As this was Sabbath work we were pleased to hand the amount over to the office for use in the mission field. At the request of the farmer I stayed until Monday morning, and not only delivered the son's book, for which the father paid, but also sold thirty shillings' worth of other literature besides.

VALUE OF INFLUENCE.

Canvassers in the past have often failed to make use of the influence others can lend. I will cite one case as an example. While canvassing in Dergholm, Mrs. Stewart called at a home where a man was lying in a critical condition with pleurisy. The family were Roman Catholics, and the priest had just been summoned to prepare the sufferer for death. Mrs. Stewart first canvassed a sister-in-law of the patient, and received her order; then the wife appeared, and between her sobs said she would take one, and seemed moved to a greater degree of sympathy with our work than possibly she could have been under ordinary circumstances; for she at once offered to escort Mrs. Stewart to the rest of the homes in the little township, going out again after supper and finishing only after ten o'clock at night. The result was an order in every place visited, and the lady herself was indeed blessed, for instead of sitting down mourning in her grief she seized an opportunity to help others, and the effect could plainly be seen in her face.

Upon our return to deliver, the husband was restored to his usual health and most happy to meet us, for he said we had helped his wife in her darker moments. Upon our leaving, the tears flowed from the lady's face as she said farewell to those she could scarcely hope to see again. Now this help was received from those whom, on account of their faith, we are so often apt to slight.

R. C. STEWART.

Sabbath-School

THE JOY OF SERVICE.

"What joy if some heart that is bleeding
Is tenderly bound by your hand!
What joy of all joys to be leading
Some soul to the beautiful land!
To comfort the lives that are grieving,
To pray for the tempted that fall,
To teach them the joy in believing
In Jesus, the Saviour of all."

Mission Studies.

STRAITS SETTLEMENTS.

AS SINGAPORE is the capital town of the Straits Settlements, a few statements as to what they are, and where located, will be in order. These Settlements are located on the Strait of Malacca, and thus the name. They comprise Singapore; Malacca, 110 miles north-west of Singapore; Penang, on a small island off the Malay Peninsula; Province Wellesley, on the mainland opposite Penang; the Dindings, a strip of the mainland, 22 x 10 miles in extent, 80 miles south of Penang; also some small islands on the coast, and Keeling Island in the Indian Ocean. These Settlements are ruled by a governor, who lives at Singapore, assisted by an executive council.

Malacca is the oldest European settlement in the East, having been settled by the Portuguese in 1511. The place was once of much importance. Here, St. Francis Xavier, one of the founders of the Order of Jesuits, laboured about 1550; and here, in the old cathedral, still to be seen, his body lay in state

before being sent back to Goa, India. The inhabitants are Malays, Chinese, and a few descendants of the Portuguese. The Catholic religion prevails.

The town of Penang is a neat, flourishing city, the northern-most of the Straits Settlements, and is the emporium for all the trade of northern Sumatra and the Malay Peninsula. This city was canvassed for some of our books by Brother Meyers, and last year by Timothy and Sister Teck Sung for the Malay "Christ Our Saviour." Many English people live here. The Methodists have large schools in the city. Our labourers must enter this place in the near future.

The other points in the Settlements are of less importance commercially and in size of population. The exports from these Settlements are gutta-percha, gambier, pepper, india-rubber, rattan, sugar, rice, sago, tapioca, spices, dye-stuffs, tea and coffee, tobacco, gums, and tin. God has here some jewels that must be searched out.

E. H. GATES.

Appreciation of the Truth in Fiji.

THINKING our readers might be interested to know something concerning the earnestness and whole-heartedness of some of our native brethren, I will give the following latest evidence of faithfulness in tithe-paying.

About a year ago a church was organized in a somewhat remote district in Vanua Levu, the second largest island in this group. The members of the church are mostly half-castes. They have been earnest in their work, and a few days ago our native teacher came from there bringing with him £17 18s. as tithe for three months. Besides this a young calf was given. It is worthy of note that this amount was paid by six of the company.

To say the least, this is very encouraging, and stands as a worthy example of faithfulness in tithe-paying. Truly the Lord is moving upon the hearts of His people, who are bringing all the tithes into the storehouse, that there may be meat sufficient to sustain all the harvesters in the Lord's vineyard, and provide for more to gather the already ripened grain. Needless to say, the company is prospering, and enjoying many blessings of the Lord, as will all who likewise prove Him. Mal. 3: 10-12.

GORDON SMITH.

"IT'S easy to think you are serious when you are soured."

Notes

WE are glad to give our readers so many good reports from the home and mission fields this week.

WE are glad to learn from Tonga's letter of his success in canvassing on the island of Aitutaki. This will add a new item to our next canvasser's summary. We shall hope to receive regular reports from Tonga while he is engaged in canvassing.

MR. HALL, a minister and teacher of the London Missionary Society, called on Brother Lyndon in Rarotonga and gave him a subscription for the *Tuatua-Mou* for a year. He also wanted the back numbers from the beginning, which Brother Lyndon was not able to furnish.

SEVERAL parties of young people have been out during the holidays in the vicinity of Sydney canvassing for the *Young People's Magazine*. We have not received definite reports of their work, but understand that a good many yearly subscriptions have been taken, and many single copies sold.

IN passing through Suva on her way home from Australia, Sister Parker visited Brother and Sister Marriott. Brother Marriott is busy holding Bible-readings and canvassing, and Sister Marriott is quite enthusiastic over the little native school which she daily teaches for a few hours. Seed is being sown which will doubtless bear fruit ere long.

FROM a letter received from Sister Andre, posted at Melbourne, we learn that she and Brother and Sister Hennig had a very smooth passage to that their first port of call. They speak very highly of the accommodation afforded on the s.s. *Roon*, and of the attention they receive. On the whole they have made a very favourable start on their long sea voyage.

SISTER ELLA BOYD, accompanied by a young Tongan sister named Vai Valmola, arrived in Sydney on the *Atua*, Wednesday, December 30. They had a pleasant voyage from Tonga, and called at Samoa and Fiji on their way over. Sister Boyd has promised us a report for our next issue. It will be remembered that Sister Boyd has been called to connect with the Avondale School as teacher for the coming year, Brother and Sister H. E. Piper having taken her place at Haapai in the Tongan Group.

PASTOR LYNDON writes: "From the other islands I have, by every mail, communications concerning our literature. Two persons recently came over from the Penrhyn Islands inquiring after literature on the Bible. It is very encouraging to have such a spirit of inquiry." The Penrhyn Islands are several hundred miles from Rarotonga. The interest awakened there has probably resulted from missionary work done on that island by means of the printed page and correspondence from the young people's missionary society of Wahroonga.

SISTER PARKER of Fiji writes from Fiji on December 20: "I felt sure on our trip over that a kind Providence had led to our taking just that boat. We made several pleasant acquaintances, which will be continued by correspondence. One lady, who is secretary of the Vegetarian Society of Norway and Denmark, was much interested in the health journals, and we had many interesting talks. Nearly all the passengers on deck could be seen occasionally perusing the copies of the *Good Health* with which the Wahroonga Missionary Society had provided me. A copy of 'Ministry of Healing' was read with interest by several of the passengers."

Obituary.

MINCHIN.—Died at the home of her brother, in East Guildford, West Australia, November 27, 1908, Sister Elizabeth Minchin, of diabetes, aged 52 years, 9 months, and 24 days. Sister Minchin was a cripple through rheumatism from the age of fifteen, being confined the most of her life to her wheel-chair. She embraced present truth nearly three years ago, through Bible-studies conducted by Brother W. G. Brittain. She patiently bore her sufferings to the last. She was a member of the Midland Junction Church, and for a time filled the office of church clerk. The church miss her, and she will also be missed at our annual gatherings, where she was daily wheeled to the large pavilion to listen to words of life and truth. A large circle of relatives mourn their loss; but she peacefully sleeps in Jesus, and soon He will call her forth to that life where infirmities are unknown. The funeral was largely attended. Words of hope and comfort were spoken by the writer from Rev. 14: 13, 14.

E. HILLIARD.

For Sale.

A BICYCLE.—Wanted to sell a free-wheel two-gear (68 and 82) chainless high-grade Columbia bicycle. Cost price new, £27 10s. Valued now by Columbia agent, Sydney, at £12 10s. Will take £10 for it. Tires nearly new. Two good saddles, chainless parts and free-wheel, guaranteed for eight years.

Address G. B. S., Sanitarium, Wahroonga.

EACH day is a new life and an abridgment of the whole. I will so live as if I accounted every day my first and my last; and as if I began to live but then and should live no more afterwards. —*Joseph Hall.*

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An Interesting Letter.

[Tonga, a deacon of our church at Rarotonga, who is our first canvasser to the other islands of the group, writes an interesting letter, of which we give the following translation.]

AITUTAKI, December 6, 1908.

TO THE BELOVED IN CHRIST JESUS, in the land of Australia.

Greetings to you in the name of the Lord, and may His love be over us all.

It is I, Tonga, your brother, that am writing to you at this time. While here in Aitutaki, a letter comes from across the sea, from Australia, telling me of the forward movement of this message in all lands. This makes my heart rejoice, and I feel encouraged and strengthened to go forward with my work. The people in this land are kind and are not unmindful to entertain strangers. I have received much hospitality at their hands.

In regard to the truth, they do not obey, as yet. I have taught and preached to them on the Sabbath days, and thought that surely now they would obey the truth, but they have not.

During the month of November I have sold eighty-three books—sixty-three copies of "Thoughts on Daniel" and twenty copies of "Christ Our Saviour." There are very many who would like to buy our books, but do not have the ready cash. I may return here at some future date, but my face now is set towards Mangaia. There are other things that I would like to write about, but cannot do so at this time, having many things to do.

Do not forget me, but pray for me, and pray without ceasing. In this way alone will prosperity attend me in my efforts here.

Farewell; after I have been in Mangaia I shall then proceed to the other islands of the group. According to the Lord's good hand upon me, I shall write to you again. Enough.

From your brother,
TONGA.

Among the Maoris.

BROTHER READ SMITH, in a letter dated December 15, gives us the following very interesting account of what he and his wife are doing among the Maoris. He writes:—

During our stay of one month here at Tolago Bay, we have been kept very busy treating the sick. We have given many treatments, and have enjoyed helping the people. They are very appreciative. We secure one of the children of the neighbourhood, when we can, to act as interpreter, as we have difficulty in communicating otherwise, not knowing the language.

Our worst case so far has been one of asthma. We were sent for by the friends of this sufferer, a woman, and found her gasping for breath and raising blood, she having lung trouble as well. Her temperature was 104, and her pulse 120 per minute. However, by constant attention and treatment, she became convalescent in a little over a week, and then she knelt with us in thanksgiving for her recovery. We praise our God. He is blessing us.

After having been here one month, we have received instructions to remove to Tokomaru Bay, twenty-six miles farther up the coast, where we expect to be living next week. We made a visit to this place last week, as the daughter of the chief of Tokomaru was sick and sent for us. After a few days' treatment the patient was relieved from pain, and is now getting on well. For this we give thanks to our Source of help and strength.

The chief has a nice house to entertain the *pakeha*, that is, the foreigner or white man. He himself and numbers of others sleep on the floor, as is their custom, in a large one-roomed Maori house. He escorted us to this pleasant house for the white man, and showed us to our room where we were to sleep, and then to the sitting-room and kitchen. Everything was new and clean, and fitted up as a European house. In the bedroom were a handsome bedstead, bedding, duchesse chest, wash-stand, floor cloth, curtains and blinds, etc., while the other rooms were just as fittingly furnished.

It will be interesting to you to know that while we are treating a patient, the near friends, numbering six or eight perhaps, are onlookers, wonderfully interested in the methods of treatment. In addition to this audience it is not unusual for a pet sheep or lamb or one or two pet pigs to find their way into the sick-room. The people are all the while talking in their native tongue—no doubt respecting the treatments. We sing to them when the patient is well enough, and they show their appreciation.

Hitherto Mrs. Smith and I have visited and worked together, as there are so few facilities for giving treatment. Wood sometimes has to be found, water carried, the fire made, etc., which of course means much work; but we get over more ground in this way. We can tell you more when settled at Tokomaru Bay.

The Maoris and Health Reform.

AFTER spending some days in Gisborne working with the Prohibition *Signs*, Brother and Sister Smith came to Tolago, where Mrs. Carswell and the writer have been living for some months. We were glad to see these workers, and to welcome them to "Maoriland" and the work for the Maoris.

Already they have had opportunity to labour for the physical well-being of the Maoris. In Tolago men, women, and children have been treated for various ailments. One patient whose temperature was quite high was, by the divine blessing on the treatment, restored to a normal condition.

It is plain to us that many of the sicknesses of our Maori neighbours are the result of their ignorance or disregard of the most simple precautions for preserving health. We intend through our Maori paper to give them such instruction for the preservation of health, and also for the treatment of simple diseases, that those who read will not always be in ignorance of the simpler rules of health. These articles we hope Brother and Sister Smith will provide.

On a trip which we lately made to Tokomaru Bay, Brother and Sister Smith gave treatment to the daughter-in-law of the Maori chief of that place. Her suffering was relieved, and her gratitude was shown in a practical way by pressing a one-pound note into Sister Smith's hand on parting. This was handed over for mission purposes by our sister just when funds were low, and seemed quite a providential gift.

As there is no medical worker in Tokomaru and sickness is common, it was thought best by all our little company, after seeking divine guidance, that Brother and Sister Smith should settle there for the present, and work for the physical and spiritual needs of the people in that place.

After the camp-meeting, which the writer is now expecting to attend, we hope to visit many new places and labour for the people as the Lord may indicate, at the same time circulating our literature among them. We ask the prayers of God's children in behalf of the Maori people.

W. R. CARSWELL.

"PLEASANT words are as an honeycomb, sweet to the soul, and health to the bones."